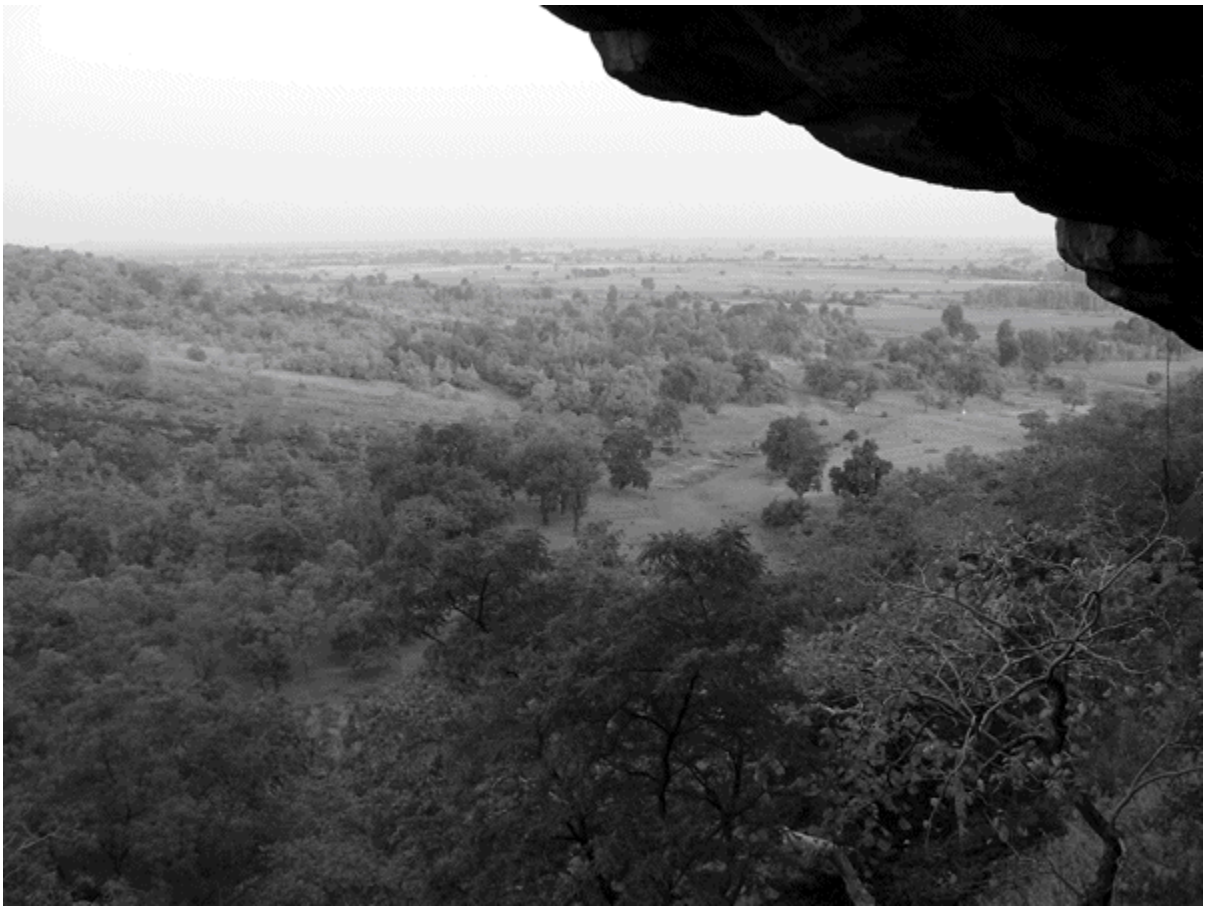


Fig. 6.10: View of the countryside around the Panguraria rock shelter

On receiving this communiqué from the king, we imagine Kumara Samva arranging to get it inscribed in a place where Buddhists were already resident. The governor himself will have been headquartered in one of the cities of the region. If it was in the vicinity of Panguraria, either Nandner or Ninnore, both commercial centres, could well have been his capital.[51] It is logical to suppose that he was in touch with the Buddhist monks of his territory; he may even have encountered many wandering the nearby towns and settlements, begging for food in the traditional way prescribed by the Buddha.

One suggestion is that the Panguraria complex may well have been the very Upunita-vihara mentioned in the rescript, which ‘the king was asking the royal governor to visit’, we are told, ‘in anticipation of the